



A Decision Maker

You need it for...	We recommend
Occasional data transfer	A-DATA Oriental 512 MB, Zion 512 MB
Transferring photos and movie clips	Corsair Flash Voyager, Transcend JetFlash 150 1 GB
Data backup and as a bootable drive	SanDisk Cruiser Micro 2 GB, Kingston Data Traveler 4 GB

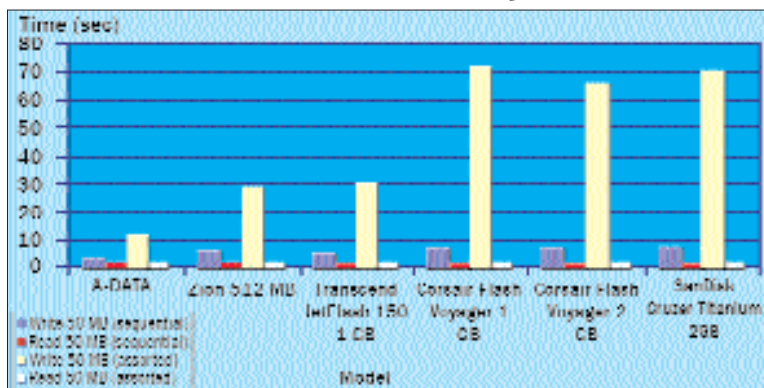
out because of its lacklustre bundle, but we still recommend it to those who want a decent, fast drive with a good storage capacity.

4 GB DRIVES

We received five drives under this category—two from SanDisk and one each from Kingston, TECH-COM, and Transcend. This category is for those who want to carry a Flash drive instead of a DVD. With its storage capacity coming quite close to that of a DVD, these drives can very well carry your HD movies. This category is not for those on a budget though—if you don't mind the slower speeds and larger size, you're much better off with a portable hard drive; you'll get much more storage at a lower price.



Kingston DataTraveler Secure 4 GB
Superior performance



Transcend JetFlash 8 GB

With a whopping 8 GB of storage space, the Transcend JetFlash 8 GB sounds really good. The drive is quite fast: it took just 56.4 seconds to transfer a 700 MB video file. The drive is a good bit bigger than the other drives (it was the biggest we tested), but the build quality is strictly average. When you look at the price tag, though, you might start looking elsewhere—it costs an atrocious Rs 9,500. For that kind of money, you could invest in an 80 GB external drive, or if you don't mind carrying some extra weight and cables, use a regular 400 GB SATA drive with an external casing to build your own backup behemoth!



Features

Due to their lower market share and a very niche user segment, the feature set of this category is mediocre. The SanDisk Cruiser Micro was the only U3 drive, and came with the earlier-mentioned software bundle.

Build Quality And Bundle

The Kingston is the best-looking drive in this category, with a nice matte finish that will make scratches less visible. Most of us tend to misplace Flash drive caps, and SanDisk has provided two extra caps with the drive.

Performance

Typically, higher capacity drives don't offer much speed, but the Kingston took less than a minute to transfer the 700 MB video—faster than even the fastest 1 GB drive. The SanDisk Cruiser Mini lagged a bit, taking 84.3 seconds. The slowest of the lot were the TECH-COM and Transcend JetFlash V30, taking almost three minutes. The full-capacity assorted file saw the SanDisk Cruiser Micro



SanDisk Cruiser Micro 4 GB
Fast, with a good software bundle

Contact Sheet		Flash Drives	
Brand	Company	Phone	Web Site
A-DATA	KMI Business India Ltd	022-30224715	www.adata.com.tw
Corsair	Tirupati Enterprises	033-22251192/93	www.tirupati.net
Gigabyte	Gigabyte Technology India Ltd	022-30616666	www.gigabyte.in
iball	Best IT World (India) P Ltd	022-30815032	www.iball.co.in
Intex	Intex Technologies (I) Ltd	1800-116789	www.intextechnologies.com
Kingston	Kingston Technology Company, Inc.	1800-4254515	www.kingston.com/india
Lexar	Neoteric infomatique P Ltd	022-39828600	www.neoteric.co.in
Odyssey	Compuage Infocom Ltd	022-2384220	www.compuageindia.com
PQI	Mediatech India Distribution P Ltd	022-26361111	www.mediatechindia.com
SanDisk	Rashi Peripherals P Ltd	022- 67090909	www.rptechindia.com
TECH-COM	TECHCOM INDIA	011-26428541/42	www.techcomindia.com
Transcend	Mediaman Infotech P Ltd	022-23828100	www.mediamangroup.com
UMAX	Neoteric infomatique P Ltd	022-39828600	www.neoteric.co.in
Zion	Abacus Peripherals P Ltd	022-40914609	www.abacusperipherals.com

taking just 272.4 seconds, with Kingston following at 282 seconds. Transcend sat the race out at a leisurely 17 minutes!

In Sum

Kingston takes Gold for its vastly superior performance and build quality. The SanDisk Cruiser Micro wins the Silver for the balance it strikes between speed and software bundle. We must note that there is not much difference in the prices of these drives, but when it comes to performance, things are different. ■

vishal_kansagra@thinkdigit.com